■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, July 20, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

■ *Canada's inflation finally catching a break at 2.8 percent*

The Angle: *After months of pain at the grocery store and the pump, Canada's inflation rate dropped to its lowest point in over a year—driven by a cool-down in gas prices. This is the kind of economic data that actually affects what listeners are paying for everything, and it signals whether the Bank of Canada might finally ease up on interest rates.*

- Canada's inflation rate eased to **2.8%** in June
- Lower **gas prices** were the primary driver of the slowdown
- **Year-over-year** gas price increases were slower in June compared to May

The Relief Check

- Are you actually feeling this inflation cool-down in your wallet, or does everything still feel just as expensive as it did six months ago?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/cpi-june-2026-9.7276216?cmp=rss

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■■ *Canadian spy agency reveals 20-year-old scientist investigation*

The Angle: *CSIS is breaking its usual silence on classified operations to publicly defend how it handled a federal scientist case — a rare move that suggests something controversial happened and the spy agency wants to set the record straight before a court.*

- **CSIS** says **Natural Resources Canada** approached the spy agency with concerns about scientist **Dennis Lu** more than **two decades ago**
- The agency disclosed one of its documents in court — a **rare public disclosure** for Canada's top spy agency
- CSIS is pushing back on the narrative that it initiated the investigation, saying the government department came to them first

The Classified Conflict

- Should spy agencies ever have to explain their classified work in public, or does transparency cross a line that compromises national security?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ottawa/government-tip-off-prompted-spy-agency-to-look-into-federal-scientist-csis-says-9.7273903?cmp=rss

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■ *World Cup delivered the drama America didn't expect*

The Angle: *The 2026 World Cup is coming to North America, and the recent tournament proved soccer can compete with any sport for raw entertainment value. Late-game chaos, star power clashes, and unexpected heroes have mainstream audiences hooked—no revolution needed, just pure spectacle.*

- Unlike **1994**, this World Cup didn't arrive with pressure to transform American soccer fandom
- The tournament delivered **late-game drama, star turns, and controversies** that broke through mainstream noise
- The success signals soccer's growing grip on casual North American viewers heading into **2026**

The Casual Fan Moment

- Did this World Cup actually change how you feel about soccer, or was it just entertainment noise?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/20/sports/the-drama-star-turns-and-controversies-that-made-world-cup-a-hit/

■■ *Britain gets its seventh prime minister in just ten years*

The Angle: *The UK's political revolving door keeps spinning—**Andy Burnham**, the former Manchester mayor, is set to take over from **Keir Starmer** in what's become a stunning pattern of leadership instability that raises real questions about whether any British PM can actually stay in the job anymore.*

- **Andy Burnham**, former mayor of **Greater Manchester**, is becoming Britain's **seventh prime minister in a decade**
- He's succeeding **Keir Starmer** as leader of the **Labour Party**
- The transition is happening on **Monday** with final procedural steps underway

The Stability Question

- Seven PMs in ten years—is this a British crisis, or just the new normal for democracies under pressure?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/20/world-news/andy-burnham-becomes-seventh-british-prime-minister-in-a-decade/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Canada shuts border to recent Congo travelers over Ebola*

The Angle: *Canada just announced a temporary entry ban on foreign nationals who've been to the DRC in the last three weeks—a direct response to the Ebola outbreak there. It's the kind of public-health travel restriction that doesn't happen often, and it's sparking the bigger conversation about how aggressive countries should be with border controls during disease outbreaks.*

- **Canada** is temporarily denying entry to **foreign nationals** who traveled to the **Democratic Republic of the Congo within the past 21 days**
- The move is specifically aimed at combating the spread of **Ebola**
- The restriction was announced on **Sunday** and is classified as a temporary measure

The Reaction Test

- Should other North American countries follow Canada's lead, or is a blanket 21-day travel ban overreach during an outbreak?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/canada-congo-ebola-9.7275782?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *AI's designing your sneakers now—worth the hype?*

The Angle: *Companies are using AI to custom-design sneakers for your exact foot shape and gait. It's the latest wellness trend riding the personalization wave, but the real question is whether algorithm-crafted shoes actually beat what's been working for years.*

- AI-designed sneaker technology is targeting the **hyperpersonalization trend** in wellness and footwear
- The tech uses data points like **foot shape and gait** to customize shoe design for individual users
- This marks a shift toward custom-fit solutions moving beyond traditional one-size-fits-most sneaker models

The Reality Check

- Are you willing to let an algorithm design your sneakers, or does this feel like tech solving a problem that didn't need solving?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Hype vs. Reality Speed Round** - 2–3 minutes -> Hosts trade takes: one defends AI sneakers as the future of comfort, the other calls it unnecessary tech creep. Bring energy and specifics—who actually needs this, and who's just buying the buzzword?
- **Step 2: Audience Poll** - during the segment -> Hit social/text lines: 'Would you buy AI-designed sneakers, or are your old Nikes doing just fine?' Tally responses live and play up the divide.

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/20/health/custom-3d-printed-shoes-promise-a-perfect-fit-do-they-work/

Backup options:

■ *Jelly Roll Moving Forward After Bunnie XO Divorce Settlement*

The Angle: *Country rapper Jelly Roll is staying focused on his tour and wellness following his split from podcast host Bunnie XO after a decade of marriage. The "generous" settlement apparently has him in a good headspace—which is worth talking about because his whole brand is built on redemption and recovery.*

- **Jelly Roll** filed for divorce from **Bunnie XO** on **May 18**
- The couple was married for **ten years**
- A source told **People** he's "focused on his tour and his health" following the settlement
- The settlement was described as **"generous"**

The Real Talk

- When a high-profile couple splits after a decade together, how much does the financial settlement actually matter to moving forward—versus just having space to breathe?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/07/18/celebrity-news/how-jelly-roll-is-coping-following-bunnie-xo-divorce-settlement/

■■ *Court lifts ban: father convicted of killing his own sons*

The Angle: *A major Canadian court ruling just unsealed details of a brutal domestic violence case that was kept under wraps. The story itself—a father convicted of murdering his two boys—is heartbreaking, but the legal angle matters: what the Crown called a crime 'driven by vengeance' is now part of the public record, and it's raising real questions about how publication bans balance justice, privacy, and public awareness of family violence.*

- **Roman Kamyshnyy** was convicted earlier this month of murdering his two sons in **Saint John, New Brunswick**
- Publication ban was altered to allow reporting of **all relationships involved** and expanded details of the case
- Crown prosecutors characterized the murders as being **'driven by vengeance'** in the context of domestic violence

The Bigger Picture

- When courts seal details of family violence cases, does it protect victims or hide a pattern the public needs to see?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/new-brunswick/saint-john-murder-boys-roman-kamyshnyy-domestic-violence-9.7273176?cmp=rss

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *BTS taking the World Cup Final stage in 2026*

The Angle: *BTS just landed one of the biggest halftime gigs in sports—the 2026 FIFA World Cup Final. They'll be performing 'Dynamite' to a global audience of hundreds of millions, cementing their status as a crossover phenomenon that moves beyond just music.*

- **BTS** confirmed for **2026 FIFA World Cup Final halftime show**
- The group will perform **'Dynamite'**, one of their biggest global hits
- The World Cup Final is one of the most-watched sporting events globally, with potential audience in the **hundreds of millions**

The Flex

- If you're not a K-pop fan, BTS on the World Cup stage proves they've officially gone mainstream—what's the biggest non-music moment that made a music group feel 'real' to you?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Billboard/status/2079068851430392070

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ *Megan Rapinoe launches new interview podcast this week*

The Angle: *The soccer star and activist is pivoting to media with a Vox-backed interview show—part of a bigger trend of athletes building their own platforms beyond sports.*

- **Megan Rapinoe** is launching a weekly interview podcast called **'Why Are You Like This?'**
- The show is **produced and distributed by Vox Media**
- Rapinoe will interview **artists, athletes, activists and architects of culture**

The Guest Prediction

- Who do you want to hear Rapinoe interview first—and what's the one question you'd want her to ask them?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/digital/news/megan-rapinoe-podcast-why-are-you-like-this-vox-media-1236815838/

■ *Cancer patient denied $12K monthly drug by insurance plan*

The Angle: *A Canadian federal employee is fighting her insurance company over access to a prescription her oncologist says she needs—raising bigger questions about who decides what drugs get covered when life is on the line. It's the kind of healthcare access story that hits different when you're the one waiting for a yes or no.*

- **Sophie Djeme-Mi Koumazock** was prescribed a new drug to slow her incurable breast cancer progression
- The monthly cost could reach **$12,000**, but her federal employee insurance through **Canada Life** refuses to cover it
- She's a **federal employee** fighting a coverage denial that could force her to choose between treatment and financial ruin

The Healthcare Crossroads

- Should insurance companies—not doctors—have the final say on which cancer drugs their patients can access, especially when the stakes are this high?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-mother-insurance-coverage-cancer-medication-canada-life-9.7273961?cmp=rss

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■■ *Trump keeps pushing 2020 election lies in prime time*

The Angle: *The president is actively re-litigating the 2020 race and raising questions about whether he's already planting seeds to challenge midterm results if they don't go his way. It's a story about the health of electoral integrity heading into a major voting cycle.*

- **Donald Trump** is using his platform as U.S. president to repeatedly challenge the legitimacy of the **2020 election**
- Trump is making claims about the previous election despite them being repeatedly debunked and rejected in court
- The pattern raises concerns he may be laying groundwork to challenge the legitimacy of the **upcoming midterms** if results don't favor him

The Democracy Check

- How much does it matter that a sitting president won't accept an election he lost—and what does that mean for midterms voters are about to participate in?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/frontburner/trump-s-big-lie-in-prime-time-9.7275921?cmp=rss

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■ *'Just dumbfounding': Tornado damages buildings, homes in central Alberta county*

The Angle: *'Just dumbfounding': Tornado damages buildings, homes in central Alberta county*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/tornado-clearwater-county-rocky-mountain-house-9.7275808?cmp=rss

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■ *2 boys missing, believed to have drowned in Manitoba's Nutimik Lake*

The Angle: *2 boys missing, believed to have drowned in Manitoba's Nutimik Lake*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/missing-boys-drowning-manitoba-9.7275913?cmp=rss

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■ *Brooke Henderson announces engagement to baseball player Ricky Castro*

The Angle: *Brooke Henderson announces engagement to baseball player Ricky Castro*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/golf/brooke-henderson-engagement-baseball-player-ricky-castro

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■ *SUNshine Girl Drashti*

The Angle: *SUNshine Girl Drashti*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sunshine-girls/sunshine-girl-drashti-3

■ *2026-27 Premier League odds, picks, predictions: Can Chelsea spring a surprise?*

The Angle: *2026-27 Premier League odds, picks, predictions: Can Chelsea spring a surprise?*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/20/betting/2026-27-premier-league-odds-picks-predictions-can-chelsea-upset-the-odds/

■ *Fans in uproar over Scottie Scheffler TIO call in British Open full of rule controversies*

The Angle: *Fans in uproar over Scottie Scheffler TIO call in British Open full of rule controversies*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/20/sports/fans-in-uproar-over-scottie-scheffler-tio-call-at-british-open/

■ *'House of the Dragon' Finally Gives Us Alys and Aemond Together and They're Weirdly…Wholesome?*

The Angle: *'House of the Dragon' Finally Gives Us Alys and Aemond Together and They're Weirdly…Wholesome?*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/07/20/house-of-the-dragon-season-3-episode-5-aemond-and-alys-moments/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■■ *Democrats plotting Silicon Valley crackdown modeled on European rules*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Tech regulation is a perennial pressure point with real 2025 momentum, and a Dem-backed effort explicitly modeling European clampdown creates immediate Silicon Valley vs. Washington narrative that'll spike engagement across ideological lines.
The Angle: *A Democratic initiative called 'Project 2029' is pushing for strict tech regulation that mirrors Europe's aggressive approach—setting up a major collision between Washington and Big Tech that could reshape how companies operate in the U.S.*

- **Project 2029** is a **Democrat-backed initiative** pushing for tech regulation similar to **European models**
- The plan targets **Silicon Valley** and threatens a potential regulatory confrontation with major tech companies
- The regulatory approach mirrors **Europe's** stricter stance on tech companies, data privacy, and platform accountability

The Battle Lines

- Should the U.S. regulate tech companies the way Europe does—or would that kill American innovation?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: What Europe Actually Did** - 30 seconds of context -> One host quickly hits the highlights of European tech regulation (GDPR, DMA, content rules) so listeners know what 'European model' actually means
- **Step 2: The Dem Case vs. Big Tech Defense** - Host-to-host debate setup -> One host argues the Democrat side (consumer protection, privacy, breaking monopolies), the other plays Silicon Valley's pushback (stifles innovation, kills startups, Americans lose jobs)
- **Step 3: The Phone Question** - Open the lines -> Ask listeners: Do you want U.S. tech companies regulated like they are in Europe, or would that mess with the stuff you love about American apps and services?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 40/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 5 quality - 22 penalty (Too technical/niche; Depressing/negative tone)) -> BACKUP

URL: https://x.com/NYPost/status/2079144952672420307

■ *New York leads nation in school spending — despite 12% fewer students. Read today's cover here: https://t.co/4iWJRYPbwT https://t.co/SgRYem8*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Education spending paradox (more money, fewer students) hits a specific nerve in the current fiscal accountability conversation and provides immediate data hook for broad left-right debate.
The Angle: *New York leads nation in school spending — despite 12% fewer students. Read today's cover here: https://t.co/4iWJRYPbwT https://t.co/SgRYem8*

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/NYPost/status/2079145992901755088

■■ *Trump says new Qatar-donated Air Force One to go out of service to 'max out' defenses https://t.co/6m5kChf1az https://t.co/LHpeyR4j00*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Trump + foreign aid + military procurement is a reliably high-engagement trifecta, and the Qatar angle adds unexpected geopolitical wrinkle that differentiates it from standard defense spending coverage.
The Angle: *Trump says new Qatar-donated Air Force One to go out of service to 'max out' defenses https://t.co/6m5kChf1az https://t.co/LHpeyR4j00*

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/NYPost/status/2079155714946220234

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)
- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Liberty's Betnijah Laney-Hamilton ejected for throwing teammate's shoe at opponent in bizarre scene" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Firefighters rescue man from s–tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 26 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After 'Bottle Rocket' Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "'Rent' West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)
- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro 'Miró' Sneakers: Here's Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of 'Pokémon Go' Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to 'Fruit Gathering,' 'The Guest,' 'Lover, Not a Fighter' and 'Incinerator'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: "Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in 'RHOA' Cynthia Bailey's photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Who Can Begrudge Gen Z Nostalgia For an Era Before They Were Born?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Emerging Directors Need to Be 'Brave,' 'Curious,' 'Pushy' and 'Fearless,' Say Industry Leaders Behind Future Frames Program" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "'Cats: The Jellicle Ball' Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars' favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

- "Google Images Is Trying to Be… Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)
- "‘Goodbye, Lara’ Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You’ll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: ‘Your love will forever be woven into who we are’" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: ‘Your love will forever be woven into who we are’"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Variety (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 14 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-20 09:07 AM